HAI '26 · 14TH INT'L CONFERENCE ON HUMAN-AGENT INTERACTION · OSAKA, NOV 16–19, 2026 WORK IN PROGRESS

# Delegating Design Critique to AI While Preserving Human Decision Authority

## An AI Design Director for a Small Apparel Brand

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**The AI critiques — with reasons**
Criteria, strengths, concerns, options

**No scores. No verdicts.**
Uncertainty is stated, not hidden

**Humans decide**
Adopt · modify · defer · reject

**Disagreement becomes knowledge**
Logged, then fed back into brand criteria

01 TODAY · FIELD SITE: A SMALL JAPANESE BAG DESIGN COMPANY

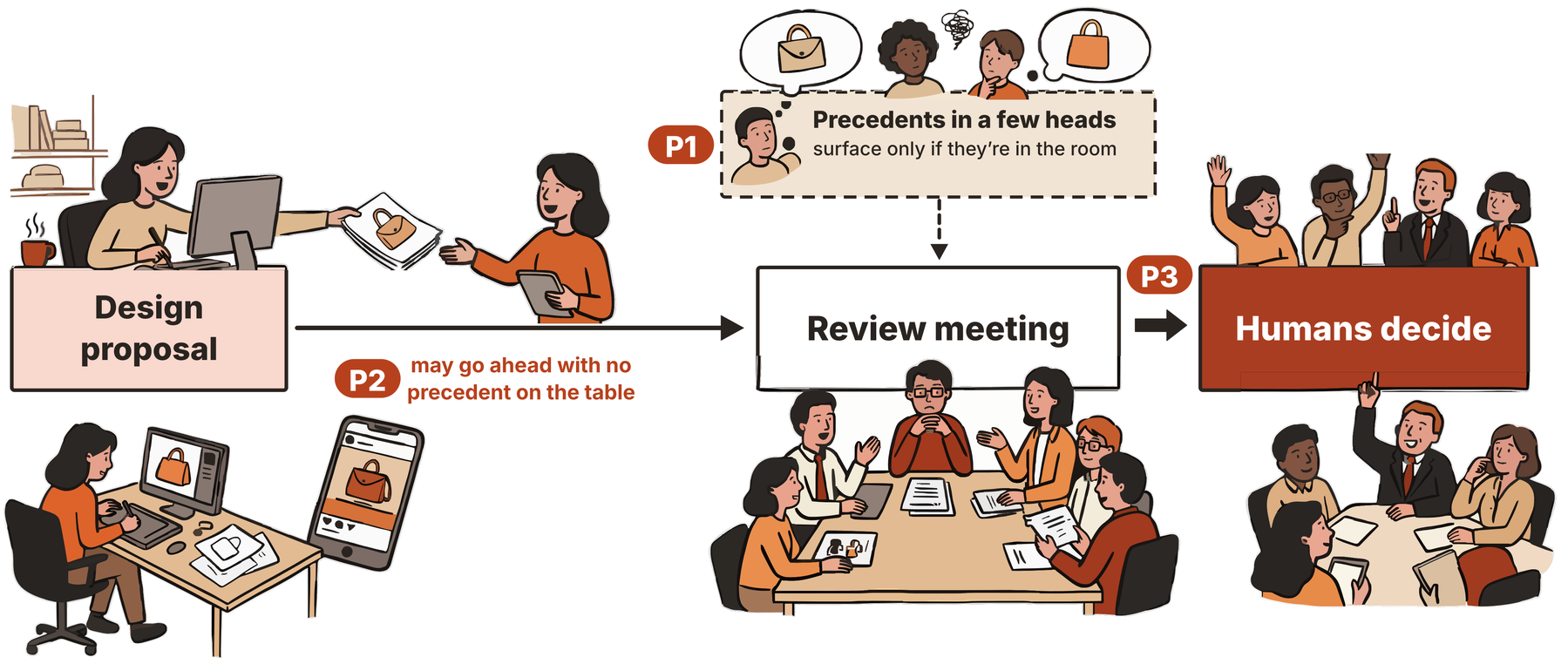
### "We rejected this idea before" — only if someone remembers

AI can now critique product images. **What should we delegate — and what must humans keep?**

- **P1** Precedents live in a few heads
- **P2** No precedent on the table
- **P3** Humans decide — keep it so

**RQ1** How can a multimodal AI agent make brand-specific design criteria explicit and open to discussion?

**RQ2** What interaction mechanisms help users calibrate trust and retain final decision authority?



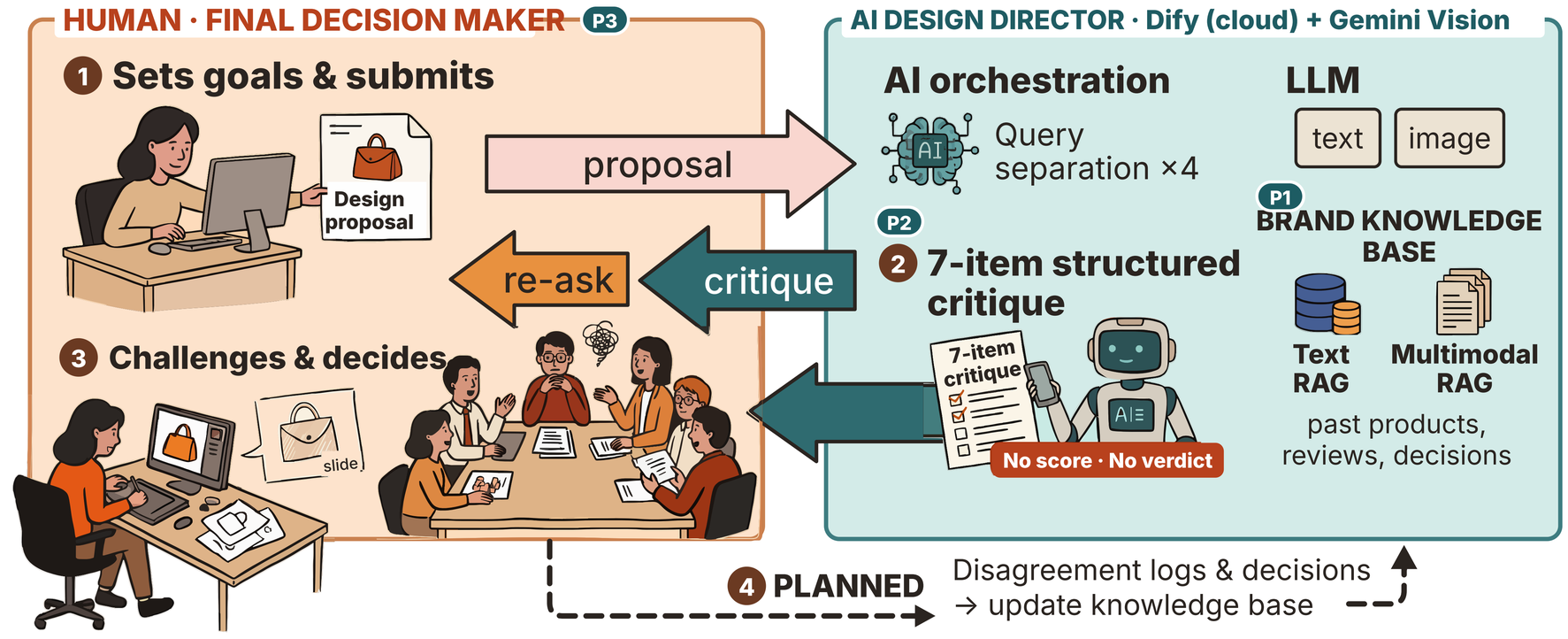

02 WITH THE AI DESIGN DIRECTOR [RQ2]

### The AI critiques. Humans decide.

- **P1** → Brand knowledge base
- **P2** → Sourced 7-item critique
- **P3** → Humans question, then decide with a reason

**7-ITEM CRITIQUE** — NO SCORE, NO PASS / FAIL

1. Summary
2. Brand criteria
3. Alignment & reconsider
4. Strengths
5. Concerns & uncertainties
6. Matters for human judgment
7. Revision options




03 HOW IT CRITIQUES · QUERY DECOMPOSITION [RQ1]

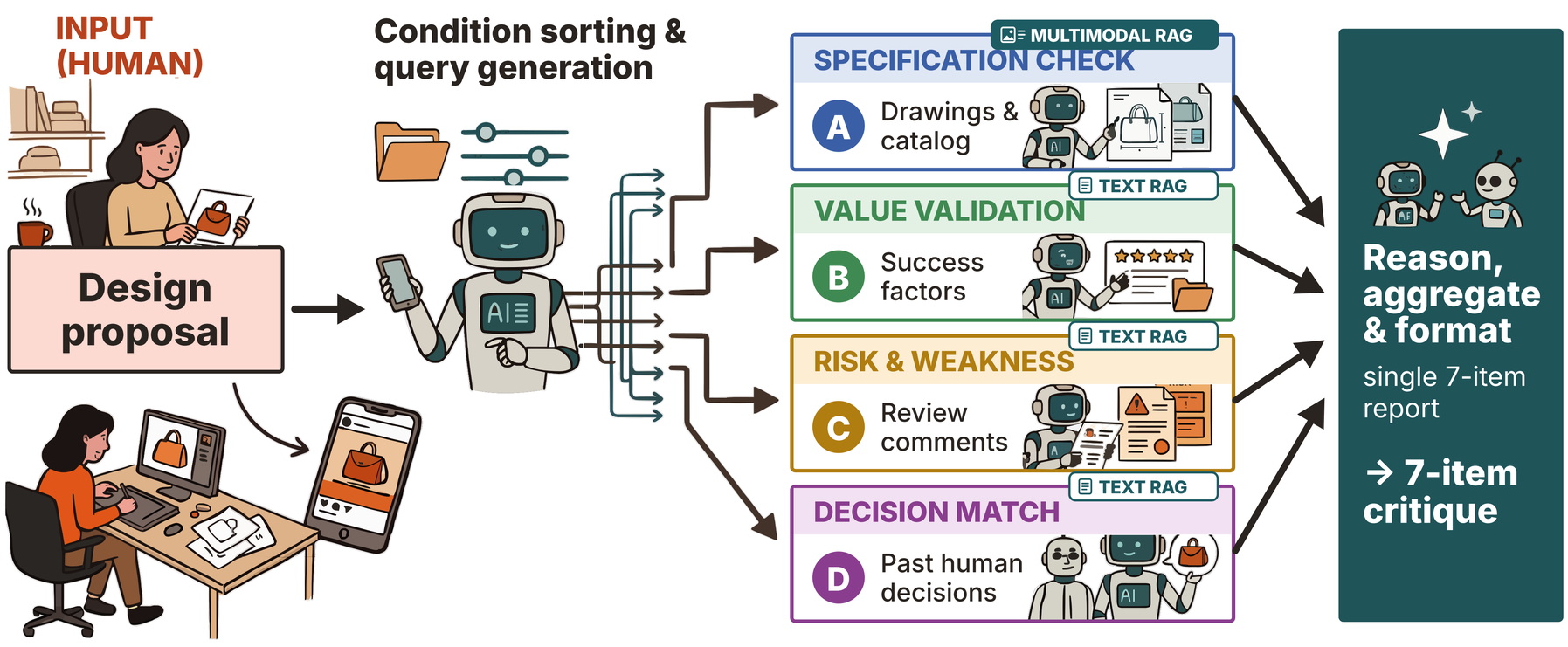
### Four questions, searched separately

**Input: proposal + 6 conditions**
customer · context · price · materials · intent · priorities

**DISAGREEMENT IS A SIGNAL**

- Ambiguous criteria
- Outdated materials
- Unshared standards
- Creative departure

"Director" is a label, not authority.




04 PLANNED FIELD EVALUATION

### Does authority stay human?

**8–12 practitioners**

| A Current method | B AI Design Director |
|---|---|

**Challenge rate · Anchoring · Disagreement quality · Design convergence**
Counterbalanced A/B · questionnaires & interviews under ethics procedures

05 EXPECTED CONTRIBUTIONS

### Hypotheses, not findings

**Interaction model** · **Prototype** · **Evaluation**

**Limits:** incomplete, past-shaped knowledge · "Director" label may deter challenge · confidential data → external LLM · **Next:** "exploration mode"

**TAKE-HOME** **The AI critiques with sources; humans keep the decision.**

**Contact** — Koji Okazaki, okazaki-kouji@aiit.ac.jp · **Paper** — doi.org/10.1145/3841580.3845722
Generative AI assisted with drafting; the authors verified all content.

**Builds on** — Amershi et al. (CHI '19) · Lubars & Tan (NeurIPS '19) · Rezwana & Maher, COFI (TOCHI '23) · Frich et al. (CHI '19) · Remy et al. (DIS '20)